

SmileCraft Dental Care Pvt. Ltd.

Patient Appointment & Records Policy

Document ref: SC/POL/APT/02

Version: 1.0

Issued: 03 March 2021

Owner: Practice Management

Applies to: All branches

1. Purpose

This policy defines how patient appointments are scheduled, confirmed and recorded across all SmileCraft Dental branches, and the standards for maintaining patient records.

2. Appointment scheduling

2.1 Appointments are booked by branch reception staff into the practice management system at the time of the patient's request.

2.2 Each appointment is allocated to a single practitioner and a single chair for the full duration of the booked slot. Double booking of a chair is not permitted under any circumstance.

2.3 Slot durations follow the standard treatment time matrix (Annexure A). Reception staff must not shorten a slot to accommodate an additional patient.

2.4 Visiting specialist availability is maintained in the practice management system and is updated by the Practice Manager whenever a specialist confirms a schedule change.

3. Appointment confirmation

3.1 All appointments are confirmed by SMS forty-eight hours in advance, generated automatically by the practice management system.

3.2 Where a patient does not respond to the automated SMS, reception staff telephone the patient no later than twenty-four hours before the appointment.

3.3 Unconfirmed appointments are released to the waiting list twelve hours before the scheduled time.

4. Patient records

4.1 A single patient record is maintained per patient across all branches. Branch of first registration does not restrict access.

4.2 Clinical notes are entered by the treating practitioner before the end of the working day on which treatment was provided.

4.3 Treatment is recorded using the standard treatment code list (Annexure B). Free-text description in place of a code is not acceptable.

5. Recall

5.1 Following completion of treatment, the practitioner sets a recall interval on the patient record.

5.2 The Practice Manager reviews the recall due list weekly and contacts all patients whose recall falls due within the following fourteen days.

5.3 Recall contact attempts are logged against the patient record.

6. Insurance and corporate patients

6.1 Pre-authorisation for insured treatment is submitted to the insurer by the Accounts Executive following the consultation.

6.2 Claim documentation is collated and submitted monthly.

7. Payments

7.1 Payment is collected at the time of treatment.

7.2 Where a patient has agreed a multi-visit treatment package, the outstanding balance is recorded against the patient record in the practice management system and is visible to reception staff at every branch.

Annexure A - Standard treatment slot durations

Consultation: 15 minutes

Scaling and polishing: 30 minutes

Restoration (filling): 45 minutes

Root canal treatment, per sitting: 90 minutes

Crown fitting: 45 minutes

Extraction: 30 minutes

Annexure B - Treatment codes

CON - Consultation

SCP - Scaling and polishing

RST - Restoration

RCT - Root canal treatment

CRN - Crown

EXT - Extraction

ORT - Orthodontic review

This policy is reviewed annually. Uncontrolled when printed.